

C51 CONSULTING PARTNER PRODUCT REPORT

Council Reporting Studio

How the evidence-led council reporting overlay works, what it does differently, and how RS Consulting and C51 can take it to market.

WORKING

browser POC

6synthetic records
processed**4**material exceptions
detected**6**

role-aware notifications

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Live demonstration: c51consulting.github.io/c51-gateway

Current state: **WORKING POC / SYNTHETIC DATA / PARTNER REVIEW**

Executive position

The POC shows a practical way to improve council corporate reporting without replacing existing systems.

It accepts a familiar reporting export, normalises commitments and owners, challenges unsupported or contradictory claims, creates a focused review queue and produces executive-ready outputs. The commercial opportunity is to configure this workflow around one real council reporting cycle, validate it with an anonymised historical pack and then offer it as a white-labelled managed service led by RS Consulting and operated by C51.

What is demonstrated

Browser-based CSV ingestion, field validation, normalisation, evidence and measure tests, review actions, role-aware notifications, executive outputs, downloads, local persistence and live white-label preview.

What remains production scope

Hosted multi-user access, secure database storage, identity and role controls, real message delivery, document extraction, approved source-system connections, council records controls and security assurance.

Recommended next decision

Use the working POC to select one real reporting workflow, one approved historical evidence pack, the operational owner and the budget holder. Convert that into a paid workflow diagnostic before funding a broader build or negotiating final partner economics.

The council reporting problem

Councils commonly assemble corporate and service-review reports from spreadsheets, line-of-business systems, email, document stores and officer updates. The problem is often the manual work required to reconcile claims, evidence, measures, ownership and approvals across those sources.

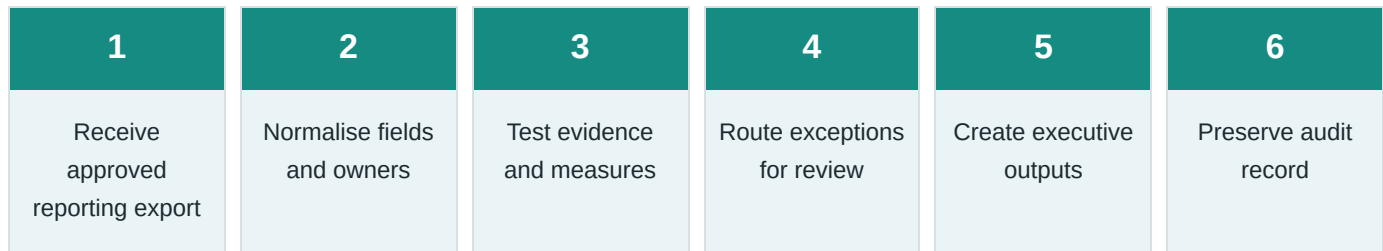
- **Repeated chasing:** reporting teams request missing updates and attachments.
- **Weak traceability:** executive claims do not always point to current evidence or an accountable owner.
- **Status inconsistency:** a service can be reported as on track while its measure is below target.
- **Late surprises:** material exceptions emerge during executive review.
- **Manual re-keying:** staff copy information between spreadsheets, Power BI, documents and reporting tools.
- **Limited decision focus:** reviewers see every update when they need the matters requiring judgement.

The product thesis

Council Reporting Studio acts as a controlled reporting overlay. Existing systems remain the sources of record. The overlay creates a common reporting record, tests the evidence behind each claim, routes exceptions to the right role and produces a defensible executive reporting position.

It is	It is not
An evidence and exception layer over council reporting inputs	A replacement ERP, records system or data warehouse
A review workflow that makes ownership and decisions visible	An autonomous system making governance decisions
A service that can begin with approved exports and templates	A requirement to integrate every API before value appears
A white-label product supported by council consulting	A generic dashboard sold without workflow design

How the workflow operates



1 Intake

A user loads a CSV through file selection or drag and drop. The POC validates required columns before accepting it. Production can also accept approved spreadsheets, structured officer submissions, controlled file drops, a reporting inbox or an anonymised historical pack. APIs remain optional.

2 Normalisation

The system converts different source labels into a common record covering commitment, service or action, accountable owner, status, progress, evidence reference, evidence date, metric result and target.

3 Evidence and measure tests

The POC identifies missing evidence, stale evidence, unsupported completion, an on-track claim below target and statements such as improved that still need interpretation. Production rules would be approved by the council and Rachna.

4 Review and accountability

The interface explains each exception, its evidence state and owner. A reviewer records a decision rather than silently changing the source claim. The POC preserves that action locally; production would retain it in an authenticated audit history.

5 Executive output

The executive view updates from reviewed records and presents the reporting position, decision state and exception schedule. Review CSV, executive CSV and audit JSON can be downloaded, and the report can be printed to PDF.

The demonstrated magic moment

The key transformation is from a messy operational update to a short, decision-ready exception list. The system tests every record and elevates the ones that require judgement.

Imported statement	System test	Result for reviewer
Road maintenance is complete	Completion evidence has no approval reference	Exception: completion requires evidence approval
Development assessment is on track	Reported measure is below target	Exception: status conflicts with measure
Stormwater response improved	Evidence is older than the currency threshold	Exception: stale evidence and interpretation required
Community engagement update supplied	No evidence reference is present	Evidence gap routed to the responsible owner

Verified functional results

Test	Observed result	State
Public deployment	Current release loaded over HTTPS	PASS
Sample ingestion	Six synthetic council records loaded	PASS
Automatic analysis	Four material exceptions and one evidence gap identified	PASS
Notification generation	Six actionable notifications routed by owner	PASS
Review action	Selected exception changed to Review and persisted	PASS
White-label preview	Identity changed to RS Council Reporting and persisted	PASS
Outputs	Review CSV, audit JSON, executive CSV and print/PDF controls available	PASS

These tests prove the browser POC performs the workflow with synthetic data. They do not prove council adoption, production security, quantified savings, integrations or a paid outcome.

What is better or different

The strongest distinction is not another dashboard. It is a workflow that challenges the quality of the reporting position before information reaches executives.

Approach	Typical strength	Common limitation here	Studio difference
Spreadsheet consolidation	Familiar and flexible	Manual chasing, version risk, weak auditability	Normalises records and tests evidence
BI dashboard	Visualises measures and trends	Often displays submitted status without testing support	Elevates contradictions and missing evidence
Corporate planning platform	Structured plans and updates	Manual officer entry and rigid configuration	Can begin over existing exports
Data lake or integration program	Centralises data at scale	High cost and long lead time before workflow value	Starts with one workflow; APIs are optional
Generic AI assistant	Summarises and drafts	Can obscure lineage and accountability	Explicit rules, evidence states, owners and decisions
Traditional service review	Expert judgement and context	Outputs can remain documents and recurring manual work	Turns the method into a repeatable service

Defensible advantages

- **Workflow before technology:** start with a real cycle, approval path and evidence requirement.
- **Value before integration:** start from authorised exports.
- **Exception-led review:** direct attention to records requiring action.
- **Human accountability:** support decisions without claiming to replace governance.
- **Explainable rules:** every flag states its reason and owner.
- **Partner distribution:** combine RS Consulting's council context with C51's technical operation.

Data ingestion, notifications and outputs

A council does not need to grant broad system access for the first proof. It can provide an approved, minimised export from the current workflow.

Intake method	Current POC	Production option
CSV or spreadsheet export	CSV works now	Secure upload with validation and retention controls
Standard reporting template	Common schema demonstrated	Controlled template with version and approval rules
Reporting inbox	Specified only	Approved inbox extracting defined fields and attachments
Structured officer form	Specified only	Authenticated submission with role and due-date controls
File drop or document pack	Specified only	Approved storage location with ingestion logging
Direct API	Not required	Added only where approved and justified

Data principle

Use the minimum information required for the reporting decision. The first validation should use an anonymised historical pack. Production design must agree tenancy, hosting region, retention, deletion, access roles, records obligations, security review and permitted AI processing.

Notifications

The POC generates an in-product notification centre from current exceptions and routes messages to accountable areas. Production can add approved email, task, Teams or workflow notifications, configured by severity, role, due date and escalation.

Outputs

- Reporting team work queue.
- Responsible officer evidence requests.
- Manager view of material and overdue exceptions.
- Executive brief and exception schedule.
- Review register, executive exception file and audit-oriented event record.
- Partner adviser view for workflow refinement and service-review support.

Roles and white-label delivery

Role	Primary responsibility	Product support
Responsible officer	Provide update, measure and evidence	Specific requests and unresolved items
Reporting team	Coordinate cycle and validate completeness	Normalised records, exception queue and due actions
Accountable manager	Resolve conflicts and corrective action	Material exceptions grouped by service and owner
Executive approver	Accept reporting position and decisions	Executive brief and transparent exception schedule
RS Consulting	Interpret IP&R and service-review requirements; manage relationship	Partner view, configuration input and client-ready outputs
C51	Configure, operate and support technology	Technical delivery, rules, operation and support

White-label model

The service can be presented under RS Consulting, a joint identity or the council's brand. White labelling changes the client-facing identity; it does not transfer source code or C51 technical IP. Attribution, support, opportunity ownership, data handling and commercial terms require written agreement.

Why the partnership can work

Rachna brings direct council service-review and IP&R knowledge, understanding of reporting pain and relevant council relationships. C51 brings the configurable workflow, evidence and exception model, product operation and technical delivery. Together, one-off advisory work can become a recurring managed reporting service.

What would weaken it

- Building broadly before one workflow and buyer are validated.
- Unfunded custom development.
- Promises about integrations, security or savings without evidence.
- Giving away source code or exclusivity before repeatable demand.
- Using Rachna only for leads instead of domain judgement and client management.

Commercial path

Detailed partner economics are a framework for discussion, not the opening headline. First establish a paid problem.

Stage	Client outcome	Indicative position	Decision gate
1 Paid workflow diagnostic	Current-state map, sources, roles, evidence rules, burden and proof plan	A\$7,500 plus GST	Named buyer, workflow and approved pack
2 Configured proof	One historical cycle configured and reviewed	Priced from diagnostic	Acceptance, data controls and sponsor agreed
3 Council service	Recurring supported overlay	A\$15,000 onboarding; A\$4,950/month core licence	Procurement, security, service levels and term
4 Expansion	Additional workflows or units	From A\$7,950/month; custom work separate	Measured value justifies expansion

Proposed partner economics

- RS Consulting leads suitable introductions, council relationships and workflow interpretation.
- C51 configures, operates and supports the technology.
- Proposed actively managed client share: 20% of collected net recurring licence revenue.
- Proposed introduction-only share: 10% of collected net recurring licence revenue.
- Each party retains fees for work it performs.
- C51 retains platform, source code and technical IP.
- No exclusivity, source-code transfer or unfunded custom development.
- Final pricing, service levels and partner terms require written agreement.

A referral percentage without a qualified workflow, buyer and budget is not yet a commercial opportunity.

Production roadmap and acceptance

Production work should be driven by the first council's workflow and acceptance criteria, rather than an abstract feature list.

Validation item	Acceptance evidence
Workflow definition	Named cycle, owners, sources, deadlines and approval path
Historical pack	Approved anonymised records covering normal and exception cases
Rule configuration	Council and RS Consulting approve evidence, currency and conflict rules
Output design	Reporting team and executives accept work queue and brief
Value baseline	Current chasing, effort, corrections and delay measured
Proof outcome	Sample processed reproducibly with traceable exceptions

Production controls

- Authenticated users, role-based access and council tenancy.
- Hosted database, backup, retention and deletion.
- Event history for submissions, rules, reviews and approvals.
- Secure upload, validation, malware controls and minimisation.
- Notification delivery, acknowledgement, escalation and failure handling.
- Configuration management for fields, evidence rules and reporting cycles.
- Council-approved hosting, privacy, records and security requirements.
- Service levels, support, incident response and exit arrangements.

Proof measures

Measure	Baseline	Proof question
Coordinator effort	Hours spent chasing and consolidating	How much effort remains?
Evidence completeness	Unsupported claims at first review	How many are found before executive review?
Correction cycle	Iterations required	Does targeted routing reduce avoidable iterations?

Decision readiness	Material issues arriving late	Are issues visible earlier with ownership?
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Risks, safeguards and boundaries

Risk	Consequence	Safeguard
Poor source data	The product exposes gaps but cannot create evidence	Define required fields and owners first
Automation overclaim	Loss of trust and unsuitable reliance	Keep human approvals and explain flags
Integration scope growth	Long implementation and weak early economics	Prove value with exports first
Customisation without reuse	Margins fall	Separate reusable configuration from paid bespoke work
Late security discovery	Procurement delay or redesign	Identify data and assurance needs during diagnostic
Unclear partner ownership	Client confusion and channel conflict	Written roles, registration, support and revenue calculation
No baseline	Proof cannot establish value	Measure effort, errors and delay before configuration

Current capability boundary

The POC uses synthetic information and browser storage. It does not yet provide hosted multi-user accounts, production persistence, real email delivery, identity integration, automatic document extraction, live system connections or certified council security controls.

Claims not to make yet

- A council has adopted, purchased or validated the product.
- The workflow has delivered measured savings.
- It integrates with named council systems without testing.
- AI independently approves evidence or governance decisions.
- The POC satisfies council privacy, records, hosting or security requirements.
- Proposed prices or partner shares have been accepted.

Recommended Rachna review session

The next session should be a product and workflow review. Its goal is to decide whether a real council problem justifies a paid diagnostic.

Time	Activity	Decision sought
0-5 min	Confirm one familiar reporting problem	Is it material and recurring?
5-12 min	Load synthetic export and show normalisation	Does the common record reflect practice?
12-20 min	Review evidence gaps, conflicts and notifications	Are the rules useful and explainable?
20-25 min	Record a decision and show outputs	Would outputs support reporting and review?
25-30 min	Select first workflow and validation route	Who can provide the pack, sponsor and budget?

Questions for Rachna

1. Which existing council report should this reproduce first?
2. Which sources create the most chasing and re-keying?
3. Who submits, reviews, challenges and approves?
4. Which exceptions are genuinely material?
5. What evidence is required before a claim is accepted?
6. Which council could provide an approved anonymised pack?
7. Who owns the operational problem and budget?
8. Should the service carry RS Consulting, a joint identity or council branding?

Required outcome

One named workflow, one approved historical evidence pack and one identified budget owner. If these are absent, remain in discovery and do not fund a broad build.

Partner decision summary

Council Reporting Studio is ready for serious partner review. It demonstrates the complete browser product loop rather than a static concept. Its differentiation is credible where councils need to improve evidence quality and decision focus across fragmented reporting inputs without starting with a replacement or large integration program.

Validation area	Decision
Problem fit	Is the recurring council problem worth paying to address?
Workflow fit	Do the record, evidence, exception and approval concepts match practice?
Buyer fit	Which role owns the pain and can commission the diagnostic?
Partner fit	Can RS Consulting lead client relationships and workflow interpretation?
Proof fit	Can an anonymised historical pack test the product safely?
Economic fit	Can the service create measurable value and margin?

Recommended decision

Proceed to partner validation and a paid diagnostic conversation. Do not present the POC as a deployed council platform. Do not negotiate exclusivity or final revenue sharing before there is a credible workflow, buyer and demand signal.

Links

Live POC: <https://c51consulting.github.io/c51-gateway/>

Technical test record: [RACHNA-REVIEW-PACK.md](#)

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